BLACK FEDORA

BY Ray Nesrym and Daniel Smedema

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Mushroom Cloud Press
278 Leslie Lane
Lake Mary, FL 32746
mushroomcloudpress@gmail.com
http://www.mushroomcloudpress.com/

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[ORGAN INTRO MUSIC]

ANNOUNCER-And now for the late mystery show: Black Fedora, brought to you by:

BLACK FEDORA- Teletastic Tape Recorders, why say it twice, when you can play it twice?

ANNOUNCER- Now, for your listening enjoyment, Black Fedora and the Mafia Murder…

[ORGAN TRANSITION MUSIC]

BLACK FEDORA- It was about midnight when I heard my office door swing open. I thought that was good news, see, I needed a client, not to mention another shot of whiskey. I quickly found I was wrong. I needed two shots of whiskey. The fellow in front of me was nothing but trouble. His name was Linguini Alfredo; his father, Fettucini, was the head of one of the city's largest mafia families.

Look, I don't care what your case is. I'm not taking it.

LINGUINI- Even if it's [pulls out brief case] full of money?

BLACK FEDORA-I stand corrected. Take a seat.

LINGUINI- Thanks…{LINGUINI begins to sit in a chair that has a tape recorder in it] eyeaah! What is this? [LINGUINI takes the tape recorder off the seat and gives it to BLACK FEDORA]

BLACK FEDORA- Oh, sorry, that's my new [clearly advertising] Teletastic Tape Recorder, why say it twice, when you can play it twice? [suddenly back to business] I must've left it there, my bad.

LINGUINI- Right.

BLACK FEDORA- So, down to business. What brings you here?

LINGUINI- My father.

BLACK FEDORA- And how is Signori Alfredo these days?

LINGUINI- He's dead.

BLACK FEDORA-What?

LINGUINI- He's dead, sleepin' with the fishes, pushin' up daisies, playin' first violin in Satan's philharmonic.

BLACK FEDORA- What happened?

LINGUINI- Someone did him in.

BLACK FEDORA-Who?

LINGUINI- Well that's what I want you to find out, detective. That case has a solid ten grand in it, and if you find the killer, I've got another one for ya. You in?

BLACK FEDORA-Show me to the crime scene.

[ORGAN TRANSITION MUSIC]

LINGUINI- After you. I can't stand to see him like this…

BLACK FEDORA- [BLACK FEDORA opens the door and heads in] Wow he is awful close to the door. Looks like he was shot in the stomach.

LINGUINI- Detective?

BLACK FEDORA- Yeah?

LINGUINI- Could you pour me a shot of bourbon? It's in the drawer.

BLACK FEDORA- Sure.

LINGUINI- You can have one yourself, while you're at it.

BLACK FEDORA- [pouring bourbon, obviously pleased with this idea] Well, I guess a shot couldn't hurt. [exits room, hands shot glass to LINGUINI]

LINGUINI- Thanks.

BLACK FEDORA- So, can you think of anyone who would've had it in for your father?

LINGUINI- He ran a mafia; almost everyone he knew wanted him dead.

BLACK FEDORA- Well they got their wish. I think I'm done here. I'll get back to you later.

[ORGAN TRANSITION MUSIC]

BLACK FEDORA- If it isn't my favorite bartender, Martini Glass! How's business, Marty?

MARTY- Well, it's been on the rocks lately, but now that you're here I suspect it's lookin' up! [retrieves bottle]

BLACK FEDORA- Not today Marty, I didn't bring any dough.

MARTY- That's never stopped you before.

BLACK FEDORA- Good point, I'll take a shot or two.

MARTY- That's the Black I know! Take a seat. So what brings you here? [retrieves glass]

BLACK FEDORA- I'm working a case for the Alfredo family.

MARTY- The Alfredos? Look, I know Fettucini's rich, but he's also dangerous. [pours shot]

BLACK FEDORA- Not anymore, he's dead. Came down with a bad case of lead poisoning.

MARTY- [surprised] Ya know, I heard there was some kind of problem between him and Mr. Gun recently.

BLACK FEDORA- [Spews shot in Marty's face] Tommy Gun?

MARTY- Yeah.

BLACK FEDORA- One mafia family was bad enough. I guess—wait… what's that sound?

MARTY- It sounds like a… tape?

BLACK FEDORA- Oh yes [reaching into pocket]! It's my new Teletastic Tape Recorder. Why say it twice, when you can play it twice? It must've turned on when I sat down. Thanks Marty!

[ORGAN TRANSITION MUSIC]

TOMMY GUN- Well if it isn't my favorite snoop Black Fedora. You know last time I saw you, you were makin' away with my paycheck.

BLACK FEDORA- Well last time I saw you, you were makin' away with my dame. I'd say were 'bout even.

TOMMY GUN- You still workin' with Officer Spade?

BLACK FEDORA- That's a loaded question, Gun. I never was.

TOMMY GUN- Siddown.

BLACK FEDORA- [sits down] So word on the street is you had a little...ah... disagreement with Alfredo recently.

TOMMY GUN- Maybe, what's it to ya?

BLACK FEDORA- Just curious.

TOMMY GUN- You know what they say about curiosity.

BLACK FEDORA- What?

TOMMY GUN- It took the cat, and poured little concrete boots for it, and shoved it off the pier at midnight. HAHAHAHA!

BLACK FEDORA- You know what they say about the mobster?

TOMMY GUN- What?

BLACK FEDORA- He killed the other mobster.

TOMMY GUN- What are you accusing me of?

BLACK FEDORA- Fettucini's dead.

TOMMY GUN- You mean he was whacked?

BLACK FEDORA-Something like that.

TOMMY GUN-That ain't got nothing to do with me. I swear! We had our disagreements, but I'd never kill the man. He was good for business. We had an understanding, quid pro quo, ya know?

BLACK FEDORA- You expect me to believe you?

TOMMY GUN- C'mon Black, would I lie to you? [pause] Alright, stupid question.

BLACK FEDORA- Look, I just gotta know where you were last night Tommy.

TOMMY GUN- I was in Chicago, visiting your dame. Here's my train ticket [hands over ticket]

BLACK FEDORA- [reaching into pocket] Alright I guess-

TOMMY GUN- Hey! What are you reachin' for there Black? For your sake it'd better not be a gun.

BLACK FEDORA- Oh, don't worry, It's just my new Teletastic Tape Recorder. Why say it twice, when you can play it twice? ... However every time I sit down it starts recording. [turns to leave]

TOMMY GUN- Wait! Where you headin'? You goin' to get answers?

BLACK FEDORA- Nope, I'm goin' to get a drink.

[ORGAN TRANSITION MUSIC]

BLACK FEDORA- Marty, get me something alcoholic.

MARTY- You mean like Wino McGee over there? … Alright Black. So how's the case going? [retrieves bottle and glass]

BLACK FEDORA- You could say the glass is half empty right now.

MARTY- Sorry to hear you're feeling blue, Black.[pours shot and hands it over] Just don't mope too long, I'm about to lock up. [puts away bottle]

BLACK FEDORA- [spews, narrowly missing MARTY as he ducks to put bottle away] That's it!

MARTY- What's it?

BLACK FEDORA- Lock up! The door, Marty! It wasn't picked, or smashed in or anything!

MARTY- So he let 'em in?

BLACK FEDORA-No... he was shot walking through the door… he was ambushed… which means… I've gotta go!

[ORGAN TRANSITION MUSIC]

LINGUINI- So, you called, Mr. Fedora?

BLACK FEDORA- I had a few more questions.

LINGUINI- Alright, shoot.

BLACK FEDORA- I'd rather keep the guns out of this if you don't mind, I'll just ask.

LINGUINI- Fair enough.

BLACK FEDORA- so, why did you kill your father?

LINGUINI- What?

BLACK FEDORA- I know all about your little scheme, Linguini. You're in hot water now.

LINGUINI- [pulls out gun] So, you finally found out did you?

BLACK FEDORA- Whoa there. I thought we were gonna keep the guns out of this. Why don't we calm down and take a seat?

LINGUINI- No, why don't you take a seat detective? Much better. Now to answer your question: I did it for money. You see, I've been dying to get into the family business—and father ended up dying to let me in. [weaselly laugh] He left me everything in his will you know. An entire empire in the pull of a trigger… aah! [during last sentence, BLACK FEDORA suddenly jumps up and struggles with LINGUINI for the gun. He successfully wrestles the gun away, LINGUINI whimpers and cowers as he realizes what has happened]

BLACK FEDORA- Now for my second question. Why did you hire me to investigate a murder that you committed?

LINGUINI- Oh, simple, so I could frame you, of course. [DRAMATIC ORGAN NOTE]

BLACK FEDORA- I don't follow.

LINGUINI- Perhaps I should give you the whole picture along with the frame. I shot my father then hired you to investigate. [weaselly laugh] But after your little investigation, I had someone else come.

BLACK FEDORA- Who?

LINGUINI- The police! Although, come to think of it… I don't know if I told them about you… Oh dear! They found all kinds of unusual fingerprints though…

BLACK FEDORA- [grabbing LINGUINI's collar] You're lying!

LINGUINI- On the doorknob, on the shot glass! [BLACK lets go over his collar]

BLACK FEDORA- Why would they think I wanted to harm your father?

LINGUINI- I suppose you didn't check the suitcase I gave you.

BLACK FEDORA- The money?

LINGUINI- WRONG! The case, detective. If you'd looked at anything besides the money, you'd have noticed T.G.!

BLACK FEDORA- T.G.? What's that supposed mean Linguini?

LINGUINI- Use your noodle detective! They're initials.

BLACK FEDORA- T.G…. TOMMY GUN! [DRAMATIC ORGAN NOTE]

LINGUINI- That's right, the case once belonged to Tommy Gun, until one day he gave it to my father, along with a sizeable payoff inside—much bigger than yours was. Though I'm sure the police will find your small fortune interesting enough. After all, why would you have Tommy Gun's money anyways unless…

BLACK FEDORA- [realization] Unless he hired me. You may as well have painted hitman on my forehead.

LINGUINI- But that's not all! You see, I called Officer Spade, asked him if he could come here today. I said father had said something about a private eye. The police'll be here any second now, and they'll arrest you and then they'll take that gun you're holding. My gun.

BLACK FEDORA- [realization] The same gun used to killed Fettucini…

LINGUINI- It'll be a miracle if you even survive until court!

BLACK FEDORA- [pistol whips LINGUINI] This isn't over!

LINGUINI- Of course not! Not until they get here- [knock] oh wait, here they come.

PATROLMAN-[kicks down door, gun raised] DROP IT!

OFFICER SPADE- FREEZE!

PATROLMAN- DON'T MOVE!

OFFICER SPADE- Alright Black! The jig is up!

BLACK FEDORA- Of course officer. But first would you mind arresting this man?

OFFICER SPADE- [sarcastic] Oh sure maybe after arresting you I'll go ahead and do that. [Handcuffs BLACK]

BLACK FEDORA- Fair enough, would at least get something out of my pocket real quick?

OFFICER SPADE- [pulling out tape recorder]What is this Black?

BLACK FEDORA- It's my new Teletastic Tape Recorder, why say it twice, when you can play it twice? …and it's been on ever since I sat down a few minutes ago. May I? [CLICK]

LINGUINI(via tape recorder)- I shot my father then hired you to investigate. [weaselly laugh] [CLICK]

BLACK FEDORA- Now if you would be so kind as to arrest Mr. Alfredo over there, Linguini alright? You look steamed!

LINGUINI- I'll get you for this Detective! And your little hat too!

BLACK FEDORA- Make sure he gets some sleep in prison—I think he needs it.

OFFICER SPADE- Wow, great job, Black! Hats off to you. Sorry about all this.

BLACK FEDORA-It's quite alright Officer, to each his own I suppose.

OFFICER SPADE-What do you mean by that Black?

BLACK FEDORA-Well, just that you prefer to bind people with cuffs while I prefer to use tape. [BOTH share a hearty laugh]

[ORGAN TRANSITION MUSIC]

ANNOUNCER-That concludes this week's episode of Black Fedora. Tune in next week for the Case of Prospect Diamond.

[ORGAN OUTRO MUSIC]